

Espanso: A Wonder Tool for Writers

Espanso is an open source cross-platform text expander based on the 'Rust' language. This tool has some amazing capabilities that make your writing effective, such as preventing typing the same text repeatedly. This article will show you how to install and work with Espanso.

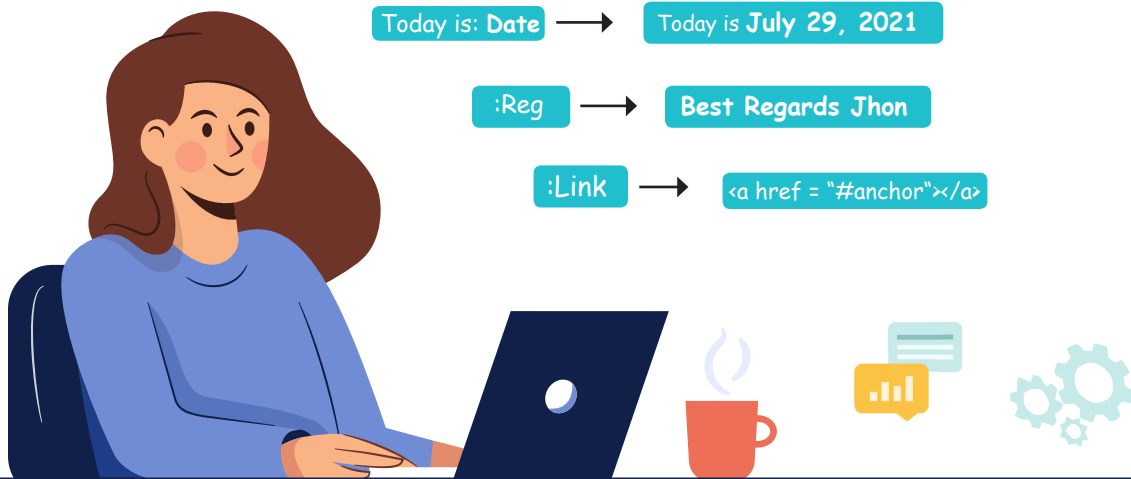


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You may have noticed when writing emails that you write the same chunks of text over and over. This could be the greetings at the beginning of the email or the signature at the end. Those parts hardly change. The emails you receive from others, be it your service provider or the shopping portal you have visited in the past, are also very generic in nature.

Most of the emails you receive in your personal accounts consist of marketing emails from the sites and services you use or visit. In all of these emails, the text is almost identical and generic except for the name of the person it is addressed to.

Some of these texts are produced by the text expander — it is a tool that can produce a chunk of text based on the text input. In simple words, a text

expander produces expanded text from a single or finite number of words.

Who needs Espanso?

Espanso is useful for everyone, but people who write a lot of reports everyday may find this tool an invaluable one, because it saves a lot of time and improves the quality of text. Especially when you're writing a lot of text involving technical jargon and you use those terms frequently, Espanso can be a great help.

You can also use emojis, images and snippets in your text without using any complicated keystroke combination, or copying and pasting such items in your text. They can be incorporated neatly with very few simple lines of code. Espanso is easily portable to many machines — all you have to do is copy the files (for example, source docs such

as images, snippets, etc, as well as your configuration files) so that you can use the existing configurations in the new machine straightaway.

Installing Espanso

In this article, you will see how to install Espanso in a Debian based Linux machine. Espanso offers prebuilt packages for Debian and Arch based systems. For Debian based systems, you can use the Snap packaging system or the .deb file format to install.

For the rest of the operating systems you can use the manual installation process, which is explained in the Espanso website. After you're done installing Espanso, you need to install modulo, which is required to create forms that you will see later in the article. Once the installation is complete, you can verify it by entering